

Nathan A. Dana

Fort Mill, SC | 1 802 846-7679 | nathan.dana@gmail.com
nathandana.a1design.app | linkedin.com/in/midbrain

Professional Summary

As a trusted design systems leader, I specialize in wildly predictable, accessible, rules-driven systems that help enterprise teams move faster with greater consistency and clarity. I combine UX architecture, design systems strategy, accessibility, and hands-on implementation with **AI-enabled workflows** to turn defined standards into scalable product outcomes. My strength is creating the structure AI needs to be useful: clear rules, reusable patterns, quality checks, and human judgment. I help product, design, and engineering teams translate complexity into systems that are usable, governable, and ready to scale.

As a trusted design systems leader, I specialize in building predictable, accessible systems that drive strategy, consistency, and scalability across enterprise products. I combine creative vision with hands-on execution to deliver high-performing user experiences. With strong cross-functional leadership, I unite product, design, and engineering teams to translate complexity into clarity. I thrive in collaborative, fast-paced environments, I lead with empathy, design with precision, and deliver with impact.

Professional Experience

Centene Corporation—Design Systems Lead | 2020-Present

- Spearheaded the 0-1 creation and evolution of the Transform Design System, enabling design and development for internal healthcare applications serving 20,000+ users.
- Founded and scaled a dedicated design systems team, defining intake workflows, governance models, sprint planning, and documentation processes to streamline support and feature development.
- Reimagined the enterprise-wide Fondue Design System, implementing cross-team processes for contribution, accessibility reviews, and naming conventions—driving adoption across multiple business units.
- Led accessibility remediation efforts (WCAG 2.3 AA), collaborated with accessibility teams, and embedded accessibility checks into design workflows.
- Established component lifecycle governance, integrating Figma libraries with Storybook and front-end frameworks like Angular, React, and HTML/CSS to ensure fidelity between design and code.

- Partnered with engineering leads to resolve technical debt, enforce token-based theming, and enable flexible multi-brand theming.
- Provided system office hours, stakeholder workshops, and Figma training to empower designers and developers across the organization.
- Collaborated with product design to revamp the TruCare Cloud navigation system through design sprints, research, planning and leadership review.

Dealer.com / Cox Automotive—Senior User Experience Designer | 2010-2020

- Drove UX strategy and design for high-impact projects including the Composer CMS overhaul, empowering dealers to manage site content with a modern, flexible UI.
- Created modular, scalable patterns across key car shopping journeys such as Search Results Pages (SRP) and Vehicle Details Pages (VDP)—supporting ~15,000 dealership websites across multiple OEMs.
- Introduced UX research and validation workflows, leading heuristic evaluations, shadowing sessions, and remote usability tests to shape roadmap decisions.
- Championed responsive design standards, accessibility best practices, and robust design QA workflows to ensure production readiness.
- Created fully interactive HTML/CSS/JavaScript prototypes to bridge communication between design and engineering and accelerate handoff.
- Facilitated design sprints, stakeholder alignment sessions, and cross-functional workshops to explore innovation opportunities and product vision.

hmc2 Advertising—Art Director | 2006-2010

- Led digital design and brand strategy for public and private sector clients, including large-scale work for the **State of Vermont**.
- Delivered full-cycle creative solutions—from discovery and ideation through interface design and development—across web, identity, and print.
- Designed and coded responsive websites, HTML5 campaigns, and content management system templates to support agency clients across multiple industries.
- Balanced creative direction with hands-on execution in a high-velocity agency environment.

Education

University of Otago, New Zealand | Bachelor of Arts, Design Studies

Rochester Institute of Technology | Associate of Arts, New Media

Skills

- Enterprise Design Systems (B2B/B2C, Multi-brand)
- AI Driven design and development
- UX Architecture & Information Design
- Agile Product Development & Scrum
- Accessibility Compliance (WCAG 2.1, Section 508)
- Cross-Functional Team Leadership
- Component Design, Tokens, and Theming
- Figma Library Management & Plugin Workflows
- System Documentation & Design Ops Strategy
- Front-End Prototyping (HTML, SCSS, JavaScript)
- UX Research & Iterative Testing
- Design Tokens, Theming, and Dark Mode Strategy
- Developer Collaboration & Design QA

Technical Skills

- Figma
- AI Agents (Claude, Codex etc)
- Storybook
- Jira, Confluence
- SCSS, Pug, jQuery
- VSCode
- HTML/JS/CSS
- Codepen, Stackblitz Angular, React
- Adobe Creative Cloud
- GitHub
- Accessibility Toolkits